

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

RE V1 V2 V3 V4



Cloudy, fog 45/31 • Tomorrow: Mostly cloudy 44/33 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, DECEMBER 6, 2025 • \$4

Sweeping revision to vaccine schedule

CDC panel votes to no longer advise hepatitis B shots for all newborns

BY LENA H. SUN
AND DAVID OVALLE

ATLANTA — An influential vaccine advisory panel on Friday voted to lift a long-standing recommendation that all newborns receive a vaccine for hepatitis B, marking the most significant change to the childhood immunization schedule under Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.

The Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices approved the change despite fierce objections from medical groups that said the recommendation had proved a successful public health strategy, nearly eradicating the dangerous virus among U.S. children.

The committee voted 8-3 to eliminate a recommendation, dating to 1991, for every child to receive a first dose of a hepatitis B vaccine shortly after birth. The panel said the newborn shot is no longer necessary for babies born to mothers who test negative for the virus. They suggested parents of those children delay the first dose for at least two months and consult with their doctors about whether or when to begin administering the three-dose series.

Supporters of the change said the universal recommendation regardless of risk was overly broad and undermined informed choice. Retsef Levi, an ACIP panelist who voted to change the language, said he believes the intention is to push parents to consider whether they want to give another vaccine to their child.

SEE VACCINE ON A6

Early snow showers sneak in



ROBERT MILLER/THE WASHINGTON POST

Commuters travel to work near the King Street Metro station in Alexandria, as the year's earliest snow showers since 2018 fell on Friday. The flakes caused some school districts to close for the day. **Photos, A8; Story, B13**

Democrats press for wider probe into boat strike

BY THEODORIC MEYER
AND NOAH ROBERTSON

Democrats have stepped up their demands to expand the inquiries underway in Congress into a U.S. military attack that killed two alleged drug smugglers who survived an initial strike on their boat.

The push comes after a select group of lawmakers Thursday reviewed a video of the Sept. 2 operation in the Caribbean Sea and were briefed on Capitol Hill by Adm.

Urgency builds following footage that shows the killing of two survivors

Frank M. Bradley, the commander who oversaw it. Democrats said they want a public hearing and access to documents related to the incident.

Republicans — who control the Senate and the House — joined

Democrats in seeking answers from the Defense Department after The Washington Post reported last week that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth had given a verbal order before the strike to kill all of the boat's crew members. But as of Friday evening, Sen. Roger Wicker (R-Mississippi), who chairs the Senate Armed Services Committee, and Rep. Mike D. Rogers (R-Alabama), his counterpart in the House, have yet to signal how they will proceed.

Republicans have neither ruled

out nor committed to launching a fuller investigation. Spokespeople for Wicker and Rogers did not respond to requests for comment, and neither made any public statements after meeting with Bradley on Thursday.

The silence has unnerved some Democrats who say Congress has a duty to perform rigorous oversight of the situation.

"To be very blunt, I've seen no clear sign yet that Republicans really are seeking an aggressive

SEE STRIKES ON A10

Judge orders Epstein grand jury transcripts to be released

BY PERRY STEIN

A federal judge in Florida ordered on Friday the unsealing of a batch of grand jury transcripts related to the criminal investigation into Jeffrey Epstein, siding with the Justice Department after multiple judges previously rejected similar requests from the government.

U.S. District Judge Rodney Smith said in a brief order that Congress's recent legislation calling on the Justice Department to release all unclassified investigatory materials enables him to unseal the transcripts despite strict secrecy laws governing grand jury proceedings.

The Justice Department initially asked federal judges in Florida and New York over the summer to unseal grand jury transcripts amid public uproar that the Trump administration was not being transparent enough with the government's long-running and high-profile sex trafficking investigation of Epstein. The requests called for the unsealing of grand jury transcripts in investigations of Epstein and his associate, Ghislaine Maxwell.

Smith and other federal judges rejected the requests, saying that grand jury transcripts could only be released in very limited circumstances. The Justice Department did not appeal those rejections.

SEE EPSTEIN ON A6



JOSHUA LOTT/THE WASHINGTON POST

A cafe in the 24 Somali Mall in Minneapolis, which has a large Somali immigrant population.

Minnesota turns cold for Somali migrants

Community is fearful as it faces Trump's rants and ICE action

BY CAROLINE O'DONOVAN
AND EMMANUEL FELTON

MINNEAPOLIS — The usually bustling Karmel Mall, a hub for the city's Somali residents, is quiet. Signs on the mall's doors declare: "No ICE enter without court order." Nearby, a Mexican bakery and a neighboring taqueria are closed.

Immigration activists and lawyers say Somali residents

have been pulled over, asked for their passports and detained by masked Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents this week after President Donald Trump called the state's Somali immigrants "garbage" who should go back to Somalia.

"I have been getting calls all day and night from people who should not be at risk," said Cameron Giebink, a Minneapolis immigration attorney who de-

scribed talking to naturalized citizens or permanent residents fearful of being detained.

Trump's rants against Minnesota, which has the United States' largest population of people of Somali descent, about 80,000 residents, have put this community in an unusual position. Most Somali immigrants came to the country decades ago and have become U.S. citi-

SEE SOMALI ON A9

FRANK GEHRY 1929-2025

Creative mind stretched architecture's boundaries

Unearthly but brilliant designs, from Bilbao to Los Angeles, became global landmarks

BY ELAINE WOO

Frank Gehry, whose provocatively adventurous buildings — among them the Guggenheim Museum in Bilbao, Spain, and the Walt Disney Concert Hall in Los Angeles — liberated modernist architecture from its conventions and brought him the admiration of critics, peers and a broad, fascinated public, died Dec. 5 at his home in Santa Monica. He was 96.

The cause was a brief respiratory illness, said Meaghan Lloyd, the chief of staff at his firm.

Mr. Gehry was considered one of the most imaginative and expressive architects of his generation and ranked among the most important designers since Frank Lloyd Wright. His works became landmarks around the world, challenged the rigid formalism of modernist architecture, blurred the borders of architecture and sculpture, and impelled new methods of design and construction.

The Guggenheim Museum and Walt Disney Concert Hall — audaciously curvilinear monuments to high culture clad in shimmering titanium and steel — became Mr. Gehry's ravishing signatures. Architect Philip Johnson, whose works epitomized



MATT MCCLAIN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Frank Gehry's works included the Guggenheim Museum and the Walt Disney Concert Hall.

modernist cool, once proclaimed Bilbao "the greatest building of our time."

"Architecture is not about words. It's about tears," said Johnson, who broke down when he first beheld its soaring spaces. "I get the same feeling in Chartres Cathedral."

The museum, which opened in 1997, draws upward of 1 million visitors a year and had such a

SEE GEHRY ON A5

IN THE NEWS

Streaming giants to merge Netflix says it will purchase some of Warner Bros. Discovery's media portfolio, including HBO Max, for nearly \$83 billion. **A15**

Bomb case proceeds A man accused of planting pipe bombs on the eve of the Jan. 6, 2021, Capitol riot appeared in court. **B13**

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Graduations increased in a pilot program that pays homeless students in New Mexico. **A14**
A grand jury in a fraud case declined to indict N.Y. Attorney General Letitia James. **A4**

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Australia is banning social media for children under 16. Other nations could follow. **A11**
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A former Russian spy is leading Moscow's campaign to co-opt India's technology to challenge the West and China. **A13**
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More artists are following Taylor Swift in selling variant physical copies of albums. **B1**

SPORTS
The World Cup draw takes over the Kennedy Center, giving soccer a moment and Trump a new prize seemingly meant just for him. **B7**

THE REGION
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